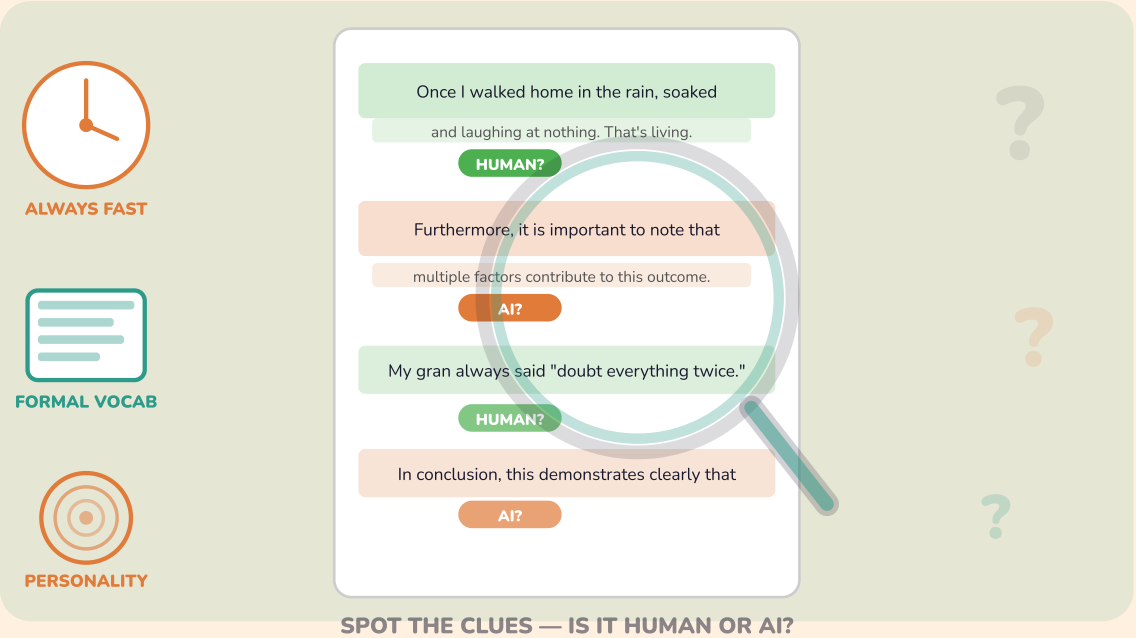
CAN YOU TELL IF AI MADE IT?

How do you know if a text was written by a human or a machine?



SPOT THE CLUES — IS IT HUMAN OR AI?

DETECT COMPARE JUSTIFY

CAN YOU TELL IF AI MADE IT?

Detection tools are unreliable and should not be the lesson. The real skill is noticing patterns — over-formal language, lack of personal voice, structural smoothness — and developing critical reading habits.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Give pairs 4 short texts: two written by students, two generated by AI. No labels. Students read them carefully.
2. Students mark clues: underline phrases that feel human, circle phrases that feel AI-generated. Note voice, specificity, emotion, errors.
3. Groups vote on each text. Reveal the answers. Which were the hardest to identify? Why?
4. Write three "tells" that helped identify AI text — can these clues be fooled?

MATERIALS

- 4 printed text samples (prepare in advance)
- Coloured pens for annotation
- Voting slips or hand signals
- Reveal envelope (unfold after voting)
- Class discussion anchor chart

REFLECTION

- What does "personal voice" mean?
- Why might AI text feel flat or generic?
- Does it matter if we can tell?
- Could you train yourself to write more like AI? Should you?

REALITY CHECK

AI text detection tools make many mistakes.

Human judgment — trained by reading widely — is currently more reliable than software. No detection tool is accurate enough to use as evidence of cheating. The goal is critical reading, not catching people out.

DIGITAL GAME

Detection Lab

Scan to play →